

High-Frequency Sight Words

Name: _____

Date: _____

Foundation English — Reading and Writing

ACARA v9.0: AC9EFLY14

Learning Intention

I am learning to read and write some high-frequency words and other familiar words.

Success Criteria

- I can read common high-frequency words on sight.
- I can write high-frequency words correctly.
- I can use high-frequency words in a sentence.

Some Words Just Need Remembering

High-frequency words like 'the', 'was' and 'said' don't always sound out easily — learn to recognise them by sight so you can read fast.

Worked Example

Sight word: 'said'

Use in a sentence: "I said hello to my friend."

Part A — Warm Up

Circle the high-frequency word: **the kangaroo umbrella**

True or False: 'was' is a high-frequency word we should recognise by sight.

Write the word that means 'to look at' and is a high-frequency word: _____ (hint: rhymes with 'she')

Part B — Core Skills

Read and copy these 4 high-frequency words: *the, was, said, they*

Write a sentence using the word 'was'.

Circle the correctly spelled high-frequency word: **sed said sayd**

Write a sentence using the word 'they'.

High-Frequency Word Bank

the • was • said • they • you • are • have • like • went • saw

Working Space — Write Each Sight Word 3 Times: the, was, said, they

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Part C — Challenge: The Weekend Recount

A Foundation student wrote about their weekend: "I went to the park. I saw a dog. They said it was friendly."

Q8. Circle all the high-frequency words in the sentence above.

Q9. Write your own sentence about your weekend using at least 2 high-frequency words from the word bank.

Q10. Explain why it is helpful to learn high-frequency words by sight instead of only sounding them out every time.

Answer Key — Part A

A1: the

A2: True — 'was' is a common high-frequency word that should be recognised by sight.

A3: see.

Answer Key — Part B

B1: the, was, said, they (student should copy each word correctly).

B2: Any correct sentence using 'was' (e.g. "It was sunny.") — teacher to check.

B3: said.

B4: Any correct sentence using 'they' (e.g. "They went to the park.") — teacher to check.

Answer Key — Part C

C8: I, went, to, the, saw, a, they, said, it, was (high-frequency words specifically: the, went, saw, they, said, was, a, it, to, I — accept reasonable identification of the common ones like 'the', 'went', 'saw', 'they', 'said', 'was').

C9: Any sentence using at least 2 high-frequency words from the bank (e.g. "I saw they were happy.") — teacher to check.

C10: Learning high-frequency words by sight helps students read faster and more smoothly, since many of these words don't follow regular sound-out patterns and would slow reading down if sounded out every single time.

I Can Checklist

☐ I can read high-frequency words on sight.

☐ I can use them in my own sentences.

☐ I can write high-frequency words correctly.